

Michael Yao

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Education	Yale University 2023-2027 <i>BA Economics and Mathematics.</i> 4.0/4.0 GPA. Third year/Junior. • <i>Top in course awards:</i> Mathematical Economics: General Equilibrium Theory, Real Analysis I, Macroeconomic Theory (intensive). • <i>Other courses:</i> Intermediate Machine Learning, Data Economics (CS, PhD), Labour Economics (PhD), Econometrics (intensive), Mathematical Statistics.
Experience	Intern , New Zealand Treasury (Te Tai Ōhanga) June - August 2025 <i>Analytics and Insights Team</i> • Worked with administrative tax data (full population of 5 million over 10 years) in R to study transitions out of poverty. • Cleaned data, implemented survival and differences-in-differences estimators, presented at internal research talk. Research Assistant for Prof. John Geanakoplos June 2024 - May 2025 • Microsimulation modelling of the US Social Security system with Professors John Geanakoplos (Yale) and Stephen Zeldes (Columbia). • Estimated an original stochastic process to model labour incomes on ~50 years of US individual-level tax data (~60 million observations). • Estimation parallelized in Python, version control using GitHub. Research Assistant for Prof. Annie Harper June - December 2024 • Coauthoring a paper about debt and fintech use by people experiencing homelessness. Interviewed 20 unhoused people in New Haven, Connecticut.
Leadership and Service	Yale Salus Populi Foundation (International development society) 2023 - 2025 Teaching ~20 undergraduate fellows about international development and running speaker events, including with former Chief Economist of USAID Dean Karlan. Yale Kendo Club (martial art), <i>President</i> 2024 - Present Volunteering 2025 - Teaching MathCounts at a local middle school, Volunteer Income Tax Assistance, preparing meals at Yale Community Kitchen.
Skills	Mathematical and statistical computing Python (NumPy, SciPy, Pandas, tensorflow, parallel computing in dask), R (tidyverse, econometrics packages), MATLAB. Can read Fortran and Stata. Other software GitHub, Anaconda (Python package management), L ^A T _E X, beamer.